

Date: March 6, 2025

Before going live in the studio today, I sat in silence for a long time. The mic was on, the recording was ready, but I didn't say a word. The words were there—but they refused to come out. Maybe some sentences do less harm when they stay inside.

I remembered that special broadcast I did last month. Anonymous stories, made-up characters... supposedly a "fiction" segment. But it was Beril's story. The things she told me. I didn't mention her name, of course. But the scenes I described, the emotions, the tone... it was all her. Anyone paying attention could tell. And one person definitely did.

Beril came by the studio today. She didn't come in—just stood outside, behind the glass. Our eyes didn't meet, but I knew she was looking. In that moment, a knot tightened in my chest. I don't know what she would've said to me, but her silence made more noise than shouting ever could.

We used to talk a lot. She shared things—nothing like a confession, but still raw. Her answers to my questions, in hindsight, maybe they were signs of trust. And I "listened." Whether I was being genuine in those moments, or just collecting details to be a better storyteller... I honestly don't know.

But later, those stories fit the broadcast perfectly. There was drama, vulnerability—emotions that listeners connect to. I told her story. I shaped it. Polished the sentences. But left the truth raw.

Now Beril's silence hangs over me. Feels like one day, every word I said will come back to hit me square in the face. And when that day comes, words won't be able to protect me.

My hand trembled when I shut off the mixer today. I turned my head and saw she was gone.

But her gaze remained.

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